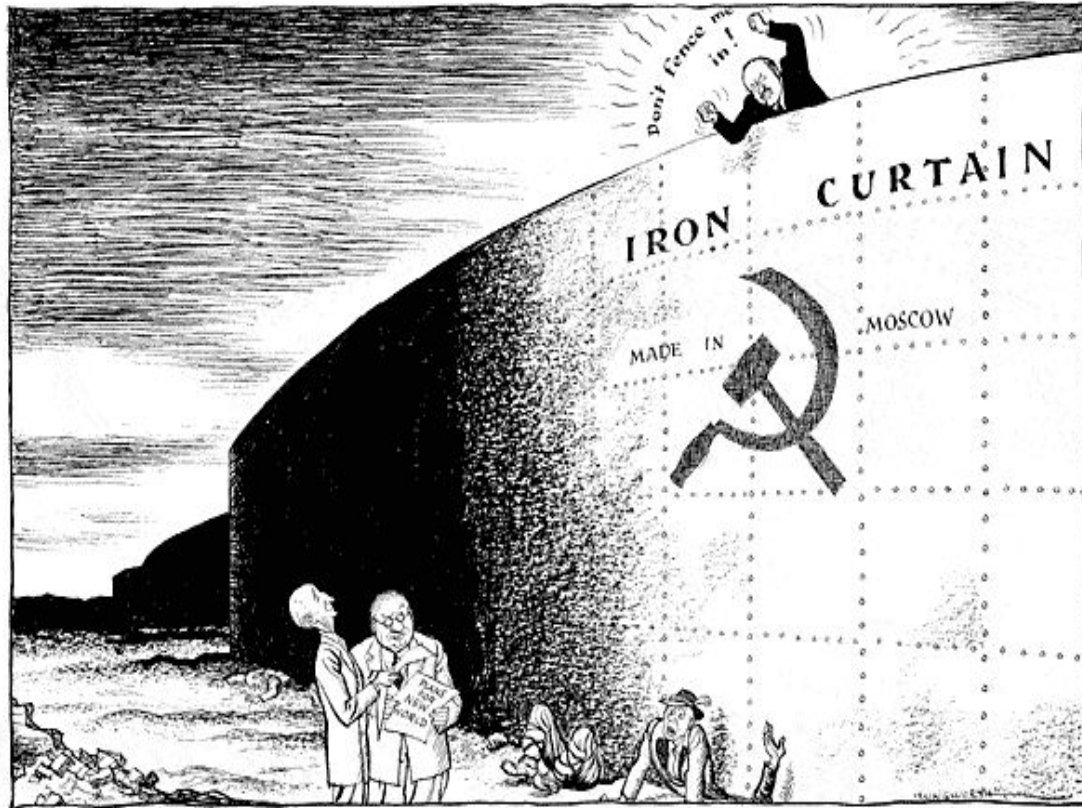


Escalating International Tensions

The Iron Curtain



Escalating International Tensions

In 1946, Churchill described the expansion of the communist influence as though an “*Iron Curtain [had] descended across the continent [Europe].*”

Stalin called Churchill a “*firebrand of war*”
(someone who promotes war)



Name-calling and propaganda resulted in a “war of words”

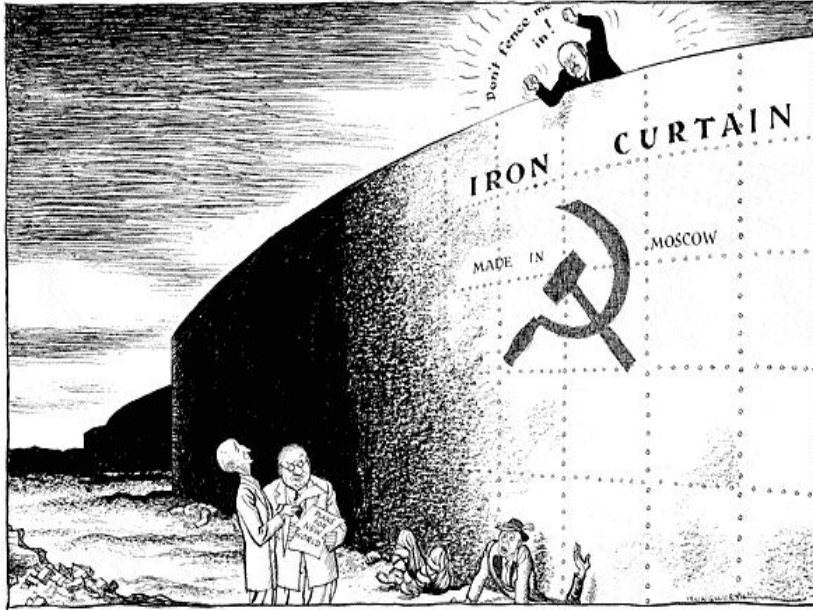
Technique to convince your own people/the rest of the world that the other side is the enemy.

Escalating International Tensions (Pg 196)



- This war of words continued between East and West in an attempt to influence the rest of the world to their way of thinking
- Many countries did choose sides, however, many others chose not to take sides

Escalating International Tensions (Pg 196)



- The Iron curtain is the imaginary line that divided the Soviet sphere of influence and the American sphere of influence in Europe

There were many methods that each country used to fight the Cold War including :

Cold War Strategies



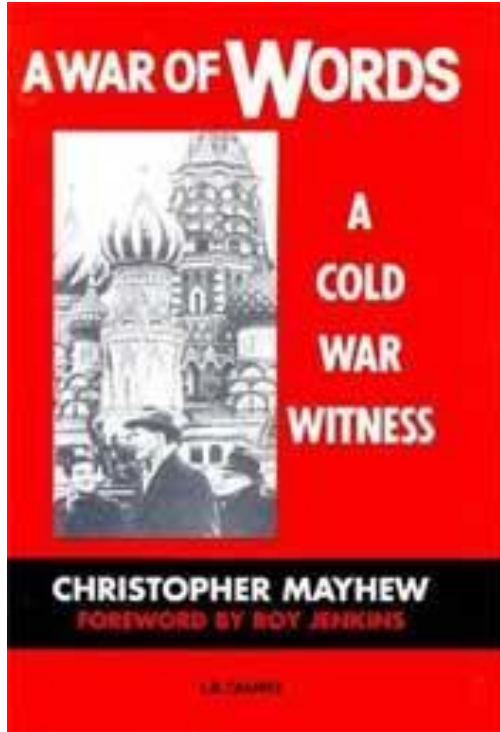
War of Words (Pg 198)



"Next time, Comrade Gagarin, where these red-coloured glasses!"

- The war of words was fought between both sides using all sorts of outlets such as
 - Media
 - Cartoons
 - Posters
 - Movies
 - Songs

War of Words (Pg 198)



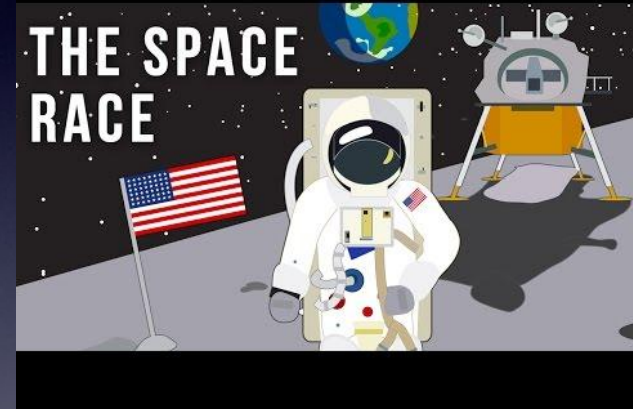
- The war of words consisted of
 - Name calling
 - Threats
 - Disrespect
 - Discrediting the enemy
 - Propaganda

Prestige War

Prestige wars are wars of achievements rather than direct battles.

In theory, being the first/best/winner is proof that that ideology is superior.

The Space Race (4:26)



How did sending satellites into space increase tensions?

Prestige War



- Examples of prestige wars included
 - The Olympics
 - The Summit Series (hockey)
 - Awards
 - Literary awards
 - Peace prizes
 - Accomplishments
 - Science and technology

Espionage

Knowledge is power.

When governments are locked in ideological conflict, they often feel the need to know as much as possible about their enemies.

Spy planes, informants, secret service, defectors were all used to gain information on the enemy

- Igor Gouzenko was a Russian who defected to Canada in 1945 and informed them of a spy ring operating in Canada
- Espionage was common during the Cold War and is common still today. The Americans, Russians, and Chinese have had a number of espionage incidents in recent years



Deterrence



Deterrence

After the Americans mastered the A-bomb in 1945, USSR developed nuclear arms by 1949.

The governments of the world knew that a “hot war” could wipe out the planet.

Deterrence can be summed up as MAD



Mutually Assured Destruction (both nations will be utterly destroyed)



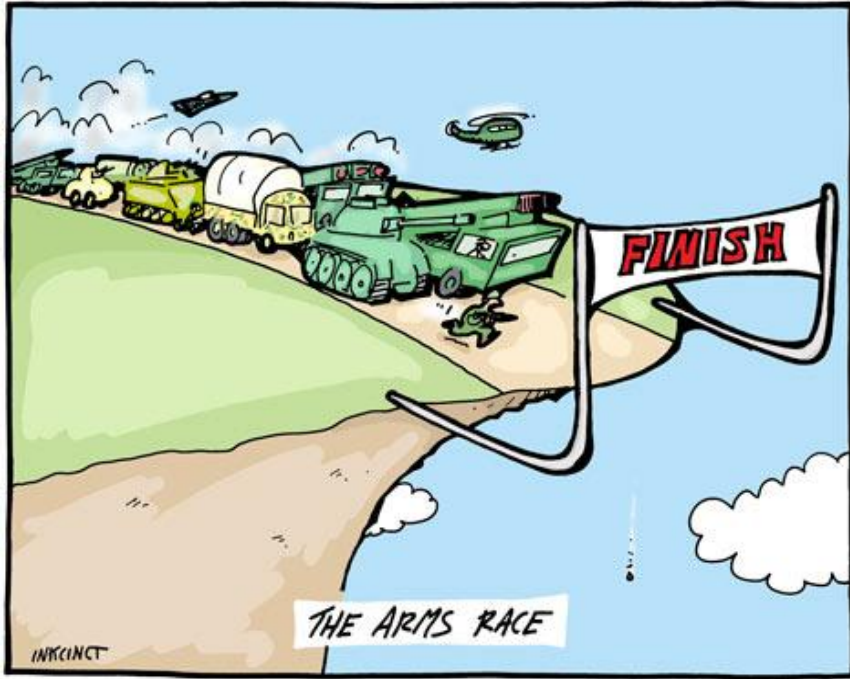
Deterrence is the building up of power (especially nuclear capabilities) to deter a hot war.

Proponents of deterrence felt that this was a way of balancing power between USA and USSR.



- Some experts believed that building up a stockpile of nuclear weapons was an effective way in assuring that no war would actually happen
- Weapons that can devastate the world are often called WMD's or Weapons of Mass Destruction

Deterrence (Pg 199)



- There was a race between The USSR and The US to build the best and most advanced weapons. This is called an arms race.

Deterrence

- Was deterrence an effective strategy in avoiding a “hot war”?



Brinkmanship and the Cuban Missile Crisis

- Brinkmanship is the idea of pushing the limits in order to get your opponent to comply with your wishes.
- The key to this strategy is the other side has to believe that you are willing to do something extreme if they do not comply

DAILY SKETCH

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 23, 1962 ... 34

© 1962, by the Daily Sketch

CUBA

SENSATIONAL MOVE
BY KENNEDY

BLOCKADE!

Ultimatum to Krushchev 'Move those missiles'

Pictured in Washington—Kennedy as he said last night: prematurely or unnecessarily risk the costs of world-wide nuclear war in which even the fruits of victory would be ashes in our mouth—but neither will we shrink from that risk at any time it must be faced.

PRESIDENT KENNEDY last night announced a full-scale blockade of Cuba to stop a build-up of Russian missiles there.

He said that Cuba had been turned into an offensive base able to rocket destruction into the heart of America.

Early this morning a defence spokesman said the United States is prepared to tank Soviet ships in order to prevent offensive weapons from reaching Cuba.

He said:

"I believe that past week, during all that time, we have been able to maintain the status quo in Cuba. We have been able to prevent the Soviet Union from sending offensive weapons to Cuba."

Two types

He said that the Soviet Union has been able to prevent the Soviet Union from sending offensive weapons to Cuba. He said that the Soviet Union has been able to prevent the Soviet Union from sending offensive weapons to Cuba.

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In addition, Mr. Kennedy said that the United States is prepared to take any action necessary to prevent the Soviet Union from sending offensive weapons to Cuba. He said that the United States is prepared to take any action necessary to prevent the Soviet Union from sending offensive weapons to Cuba.

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**How to Relieve
TENSE
NERVOUS
HEADACHES**

ANADIN

Relieves

Pain fast

Relieves

Pressure

Emotions

Tension

Headaches

Nothing acts faster than

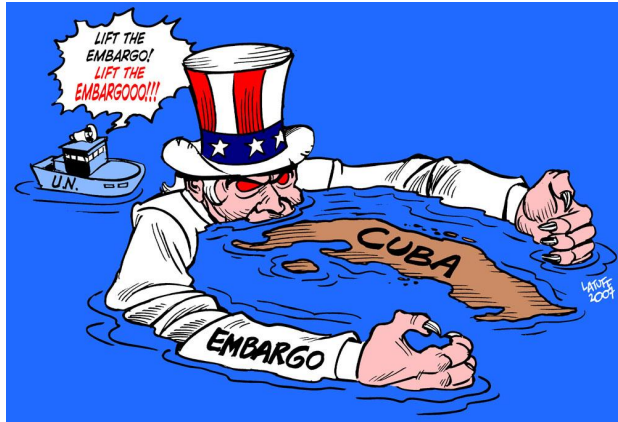
ANADIN

© John Frost Newspapers

- Brinkmanship can be compared to a game of chicken.
- The most famous case of brinkmanship is perhaps the Cuban Missile Crisis of 1962



- In 1959 Fidel Castro led a socialist revolution and took control of Cuba from the pro American Batista government
- In response the Americans refused to loan Cuba money and put a trade embargo on Cuban sugar and other Cuban products.



- The Americans did not like the idea of a communist nation being so close to American soil
- The Americans tried to convince their allies to join the embargo against the Cubans (Canada did not join this embargo)



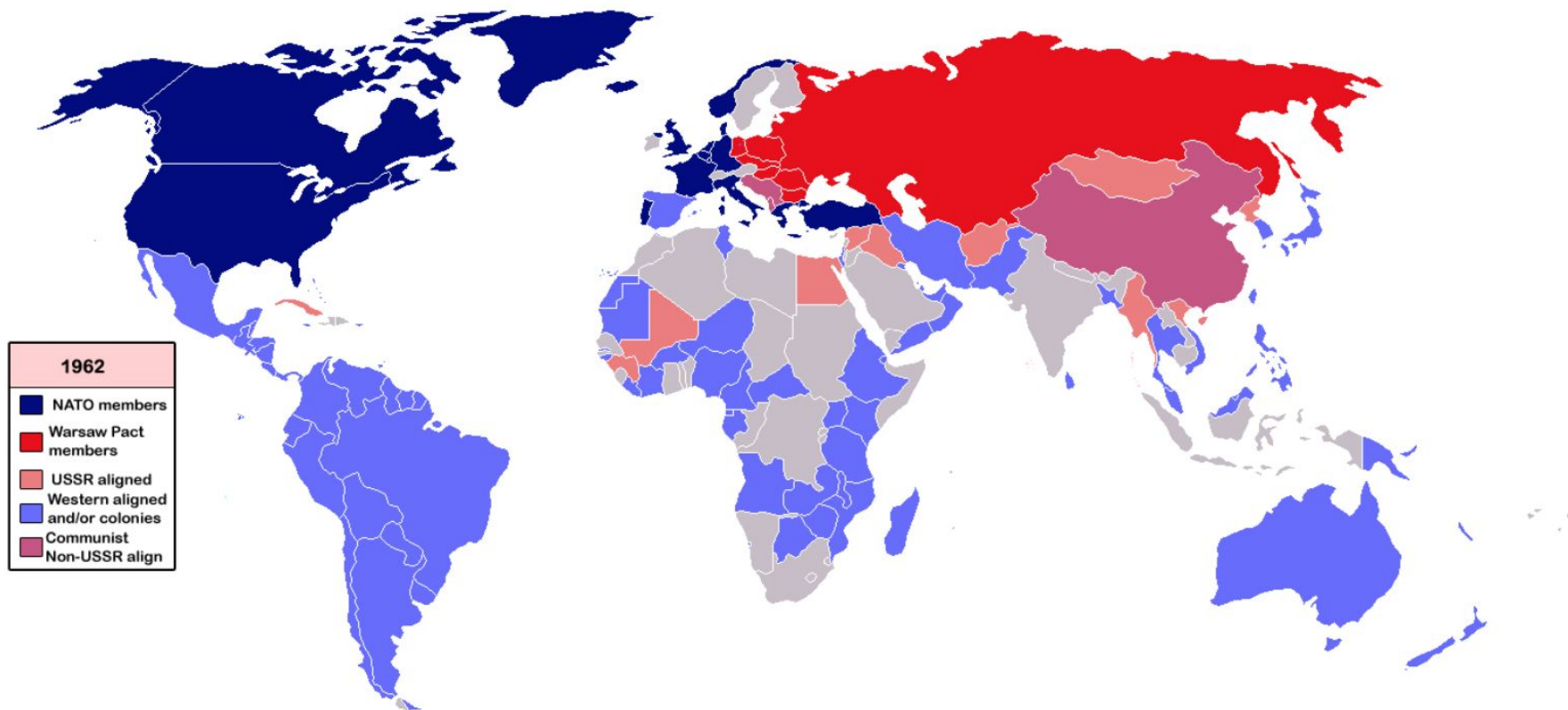
- In 1961 the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) decided to train Cuban exiles to attack Cuba and overthrow the Castro regime
- This attempt was not a success and the fiasco became known as the Bay of Pigs. This put a serious strain on relations between Cuba and The United States

- In 1962 a US spy plane discovered that The Soviet Union brought medium range missiles to Cuba.
- These missiles were capable of hitting almost every major city in the US.



- In response the Americans set up a naval blockade around Cuba in order to stop any more Soviet ships from entering Cuba
- The Soviets continued to move their ships towards the blockade. This created a massive amount of tension between the two nations.

Why Soviets in Cuba?





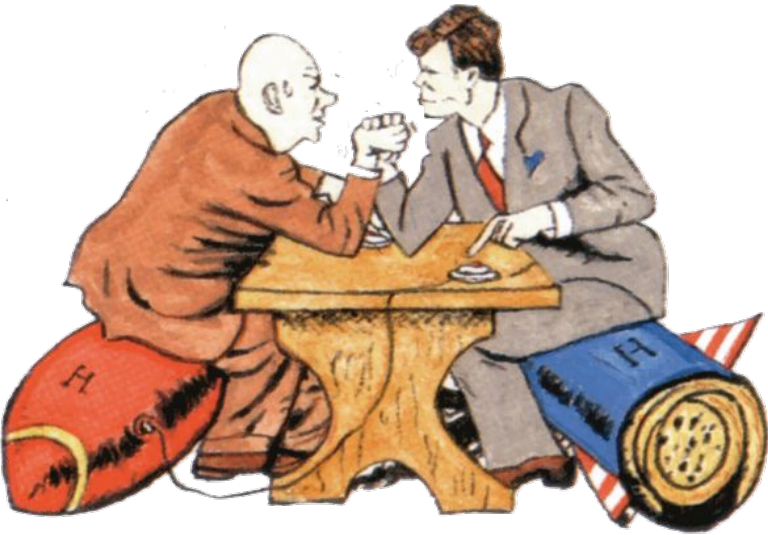
An Overview and the Results

longer



shorter





- Through intermediaries President Kennedy (US) and President Khrushchev (USSR) worked out an agreement that would halt the crisis

"...Mr President, you and I should not now pull on the ends of the rope in which you have tied a knot of war, because the harder you and I pull, the tighter this knot will become."

- nikita khrushchev

- Terms of the agreement
 - Americans would promise not to attack Cuba
 - Americans would remove their missiles from Turkey
 - The Soviets would remove their missiles from Cuba
 - The Soviets would turn their ships around

- Do you think the Americans were justified in their treatment and response to Cuba and the Cuban Missile Crisis? Justify your response.



- Canada, due to its close proximity and relations, was considered to be apart of the US sphere of influence.
- However, Canada did not always follow the guidance and wishes of the US.
- In terms of Cuba, Canada has always held a strong relationship that continues to this day.
- We will see other examples of Canadian independence from the US.

Proxy Wars

A war that results when 2 countries use third parties or countries as alternatives to fighting each other directly.



- A proxy war is a hot war that did not directly involve the two superpowers but each side of the conflict had one the backing of a super power.
- Some Examples of Proxy Wars include
 - The Korean War
 - The Vietnam War
 - The Soviet War in Afghanistan

Proxy Wars (Pg 203)



- Japan Occupied Korea during the Second World War
- The Soviets agreed to attack Korea but only advance as far as the 38th Parallel
- The Soviets were successful in liberating Korea. After the war the two superpowers agreed to split Korea into two zones of occupation



- Free elections were to be held in Korea in 1947, but the soviets did not allow this to occur in the North
- Elections were held in the south and the Republic of Korea was formed in 1948
- A communist nation was created in the north as The Korean People's Republic



- The Soviets left the North in 1948 and the American were gone from the south in 1949

Leader of North Korea, Kim Il-Sung, wanted to reunify
Korea under a communist government...



He planned to attack the south.



- In 1950 Stalin gave the order to the Communist government in the north to attack the south.
- The Soviets supplied the North Koreans with weapons
- The United Nations , with the backing of the US and 15 other countries (including Canada), sent troops to aid South Korea.



- The original objective of the UN was to protect South Korea.
- However, after pushing the North Koreans back to their borders, they continued into North Korea
- The Chinese did not like this and looked at this as American aggression. China entered the war in 1950 with Soviet support.

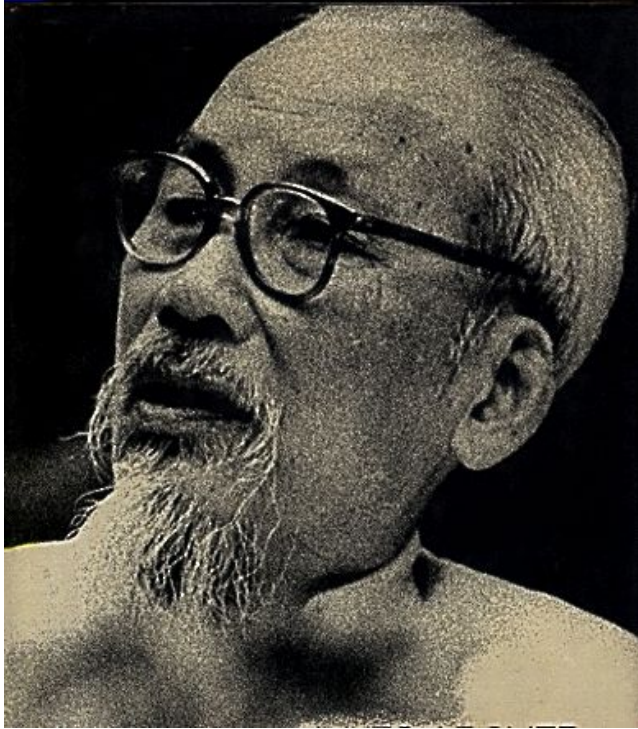
- A ceasefire was negotiated, with the help of Canadians, in 1953, which ended the Korean War
- The Americans officially do not consider this a war, but instead refer to it as a police action.



- The Vietnam War was similar to the Korean War in such that it was an extension of the Cold War and competing ideologies
- The French had historically controlled the Indo China region (Vietnam, Laos, Cambodia) in the 1800's



- Japan took over the region during the Second World War
- After the defeat of Japan, France retook control of the region.



- In 1954, Ho Chi Minh, a communist, led a successful resistance to remove the French from the region.
- In the same year a conference in Geneva was established to discuss the Vietnam situation



- At the convention it was decided that Vietnam, like in Korea, would be split into two countries, North and South.
- Elections were to take place in two years in both regions



- However, like in North Korea, the elections never took place
- The Americans feared that the more populated north (communists) would take over the less populated south (liberalists)



- As early as 1956 the Americans were sending troops and advisors to support South Vietnam
- The Soviets and the Chinese sent troops and weapons to North Vietnam

The Vietnam War



By 1966, almost half a million US troops in Vietnam fighting the north

Over 1 million Vietnamese civilians and 58,000 US troops
died during the war.

Results?

Communist north (receiving weapons and supplies from the Soviets and China) took control of Vietnam in 1975.



The Soviet War in Afghanistan

In 1979, USSR invaded Afghanistan to support pro-communist regime, Marxist People's Democratic Party of Afghanistan



USSR trying to help PDPA in its fight against the Mujahedeen.
A Muslim group's resistance

It was hard for the Soviets to win in Afghanistan because:

- A) USA and other Arab Islamic countries (i.e. Saudi Arabia) sent weapons, provisions and support to Mujahideen
- B) The people of Afghanistan tended to have a stronger sense of loyalty to their clan over their government
- C) There was a lack of support from rural populations

Because the rural populations supported the Mujahideen, they suffered many casualties.

Rural populations (everywhere) tend to be more conservative.

Anti-communist $\longrightarrow$ Atheist + collectivization of farms

The Soviets retreated in 1989.



It was their version of the Vietnam War defeat.

Reducing International Tensions

During the cold war, the world came dangerously close to nuclear destruction.

Propaganda, espionage, arms race, brinkmanship can all *increase tensions...*



John Lennon's Give Peace a Chance Campaign

Diplomacy

The art and practice of conducting negotiations between representatives of states (countries).



Canada, for example, has a long history of helping countries find peaceful resolutions to their conflicts.

Ping-Pong Diplomacy

Believe it or not, the game of ping-pong greatly eased tensions between the democratic USA and communist China in the early 1970s.



Ping-Pong Diplomacy



Some countries approach conflict between opposing countries by avoiding involvement.

Remember when Truman said that every nation must choose between alternative ways of life?

The Ban-dung Conference of 1955 was meeting of Asian and African states (many newly independent) to promote Afro-Asian co-operation, and to oppose any attempt by the USA and USSR to include them in their sphere of influence.

This began a movement known as **non-alignment**, where many countries chose not to side with either the USA or USSR.



Some countries chose their own entirely different ideology.

Liberation Movements

Please read about the Hungarian Revolution, the Prague Spring, Lech Walesa and Solidarity in Poland, and the Berlin Wall--East German Liberation in your textbook (pages 209-211).



Fill out the Liberation Movements Chart on Google classroom.

The Fall of the Berlin Wall

Détente and Treaties

Easing tensions between the Cold War superpowers was not easy, but you know what made it a whole lot easier?...

Détente: This term is used to refer to the use of diplomatic methods to try to reduce Cold War tensions.

This happened when Stalin died.

In 1953, Nikita Khrushchev came to power in the USSR, and promoted peaceful co-existence.

He believed that although communism and democracy were ideologically opposed to one another, the USA and Soviet Union could co-exist without resorting to war.



Another period **détente**, took place from the mid 1960s-1979.



This term is used to refer to the use of diplomatic methods to try to reduce Cold War tensions.

Nuclear Arms Treaties

Negotiations to limit the nuclear stockpiles of the Soviets and Americans began in Helsinki, Finland in 1969.



It ended in a historic visit by US president Nixon to Moscow where he signed the Strategic Arms Limitation Treaty (SALT)

Achievements of SALT I	Achievements of SALT II
•Anti-Ballistic Missile (ABM) Treaty •A 5-year freeze on the number of long-range land and sea ballistic missiles that could be possessed by each side	•Further limitation of anti-ballistic missiles •Limitations on long-range bombers and missiles

The End of the Cold War

Although the Cold War didn't officially end until the collapse of the Soviet Union in 1991, ideological differences began to soften in the 1980s.



The more open relationship between US president Reagan and Soviet president Gorbachev helped end the Cold War.

Reagan and Gorbachev